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There was a strange tension in the Bitcoin market this week.

On one side, the long-term narrative remains intact: the halving has happened, spot ETFs are live, and the CLARITY Act sits on the Senate floor. If you want to be optimistic, just look six months out.

On the other side, this week's data was brutal. Bitcoin dropped 10%. Over \$600 million was liquidated. \$2.8 billion left the ETFs. And Strategy's STRC preferred stock — the instrument designed to power Bitcoin accumulation — traded 17% below its par value.

How do you hold both of those things at once? The answer is: they're looking in different directions.

This week's data looks backward — and the past was rough. But if you look more carefully, a handful of signals suggest this selloff is not the end of the story.

Key Metrics

Metric	Value	Change
BTC Price (24 Jun)	~\$62,000	–10% on the week
Weekly Low	\$59,000	2026 cycle low test
ETF Outflows (June)	>\$2.8B	Worst since Jan 2024
Strategy STRC (low)	\$82.53	–17% below \$100 par
Liquidations (week)	>\$600M	Across crypto markets
Fear & Greed Index	23 — Extreme Fear	Bearish

1. The Selloff Came From Outside, Not Inside

When Bitcoin drops, the instinct is to look for an internal failure. There isn't one this time. This week was a perfect storm of external pressures arriving simultaneously:

- **A hawkish Fed:** Nine of eighteen FOMC members now expect at least one rate hike in 2026 — the worst possible macro backdrop for risk assets.
- **Capital rotation into AI:** Saylor himself attributed \$400 billion flowing into AI data centre infrastructure over six months as a structural headwind pulling funds away from Bitcoin.
- **Tech and SpaceX rout:** A selloff in AI and semiconductor stocks spread risk-off sentiment across global markets.
- **Oil and geopolitics:** Progress in US-Iran negotiations sent Brent crude to three-month lows, dragging gold (–1.5%) and silver (–5%) with it.
- **Mechanical ETF selling:** When BlackRock and Fidelity sell Bitcoin to meet redemptions, the price doesn't care about your long-term thesis. It just falls.

That distinction matters. The market isn't broken — it's repricing in a tough macro environment. The technicals confirm it: a bearish head-and-shoulders pattern on the 4-hour chart has now confirmed, with a measured target of approximately \$57,500. The \$60,000 level is the red line.

"If \$60,000 breaks on a weekly close, the next major support cluster sits near \$46,700 — the largest on-chain volume node below current levels."

2. STRC: Not Terra — But Not Risk-Free Either

The Terra/UST comparisons flooded social media this week after STRC crashed to \$82.53 against its \$100 target. I understand the instinct. But the analogy is wrong.

STRC is preferred equity, not an algorithmic stablecoin. It has no peg to defend — because there is no peg. Benchmark Research analyst Mark Palmer is right to push back hard: what happened is a market-driven reset of required yield, not a depeg. Benchmark maintained its \$570 price target on MSTR common stock.

That said, the structural stress is real:

Risk Factor	Detail
Annual dividend obligation	~\$1.7B/year — regardless of where Bitcoin trades
Accumulation engine paused	STRC below \$100 = no new Bitcoin buying
First BTC sale since 2022	32 BTC on June 1 → MSTR fell 6% that day
Total liability stack	~\$6.7B debt + ~\$15.5B preferred equity

This is the primary risk for the next 30 days. Not Terra. Not a peg. Cash flow pressure.

3. The Signal Most People Missed

Buried under all the noise this week was one on-chain data point that caught my attention: selling by long-term Bitcoin holders — those who have held for five or more years — fell to its lowest level in 19 months.

Three major distribution waves followed prior rallies: peaking at 3,860 BTC/day in May 2024, 3,200 BTC/day in February 2025, and 2,360 BTC/day in September 2025. All three have now subsided. The people who've been through every cycle and survived are not heading for the exit. That tells me more than any short-term technical pattern.

The Halving Cycle Model: Watch July 6

The 826-day post-halving marker — which has historically coincided with final bear market capitulation — falls on July 6, 2026. Applying the historical 70–110 day consolidation window after that point places a potential cycle bottom in early autumn. Three rarely co-occurring signals have now converged: the monthly RSI at its second-lowest level in 17 years, miner capitulation, and more than 50% of all BTC supply held at a loss. These are not buy signals. But they're the kind of readings that precede them.

4. The CLARITY Act: The Catalyst Nobody Is Talking About Enough

The Digital Asset Market Clarity Act sits on the Senate legislative calendar. If it passes, it could unlock the 95% of institutional capital still sitting outside crypto — not because fund managers lack interest, but because their compliance teams won't allow exposure without a clear legal framework. The CLARITY Act would change that overnight.

The path is not smooth. It needs a 60-vote Senate supermajority it doesn't clearly have, reconciliation between two competing Senate versions, and a presidential signature. An ethics provision covering government officials' crypto holdings remains the key sticking point. Prediction markets price passage by year-end at 59–72%. My personal read: closer to 55%.

"But if the CLARITY Act passes, Bitcoin does not stay at \$62,000 for long."

5. Forward Outlook: Scenarios and Probabilities

The weight of technical, on-chain, and cycle evidence points to continued volatility, with a potential durable bottom forming in the July–October 2026 window:

Scenario	Price Target	Key Trigger	My Odds
Recovery	\$80K–\$90K	CLARITY passes; ETF inflows return; Fed pivots	25%
Base Case — Range	\$57K–\$65K	\$60K holds; STRC stabilises; slow rebuild	50%
Deeper Flush	\$50K–\$55K	Break below \$59K; Strategy forced selling	20%
Worst Case	\$40K–\$46K	Systemic contagion; CLARITY fails; hikes resume	5%

Catalyst Calendar

- **June 30:** Strategy's STRC dividend reset — a higher yield could stabilise the preferred stock and restart the accumulation engine.
- **July 6:** 826-day post-halving marker — historical final capitulation signal.
- **July–August:** Senate floor deliberations on the CLARITY Act.
- **Early Autumn:** Potential cycle bottom window per halving model.

The structural case for Bitcoin remains intact. Post-halving supply reduction, a maturing institutional infrastructure, and eventual regulatory clarity are genuine long-term tailwinds. But right now, the market does not need your conviction. It needs time. And probably one more scare below \$60,000 before a durable floor takes hold.